# VAN CLUB AMERICA

## Chapter and Organizational Constitution

**Official organizational name: Club America Van Activism Hub**

**Recognized chapter names:** Club America at Van High School; Van Club America; Club America Van

### PREAMBLE

Club America at Van High School is rooted in the idea of nonpartisan, open discussion on a variety of topics including, but not limited to, government, the economy, current events, and national, statewide, and local policies. These discussions are intended to educate the next generation of citizens on how our country and its markets operate.

## ARTICLE I | ORGANIZATION

### SECTION 1. NAME AND ORGANIZATIONAL IDENTITY

The chapter shall be known as **Club America at Van High School** and may also publicly use the names **Van Club America** and **Club America Van**. The official legal organizational name is **Club America Van Activism Hub**, which may conduct chapter activities under the alternate names Van Club America and Club America Van. These names refer to the same chapter and its organizational operations, rather than separate governing bodies.

### SECTION 2. MISSION STATEMENT

Club America empowers the next generation of bold, free-thinking high school leaders. Our mission is to educate students on the importance of freedom, free markets, and limited government while building a strong network of trailblazers ready to lead in their schools and communities. Through civic engagement, peer-to-peer education, and student-led initiatives, Club America chapters spark conversations, encourage lawful voter registration and civic participation, and redefine what it means to be a young leader in America.

Turning Point USA provides educational resources that may include activism pamphlets, short videos, contributor speeches, and in-person support by staff. Use of outside materials, guests, and activities remains subject to applicable school rules and approval processes.

### SECTION 3. SCHOOL REGISTRATION

The chapter shall exercise independent internal decision-making in accordance with the national Club America and Turning Point USA organizational framework, to the extent applicable, and the policies of Van High School and Van Independent School District. The Executive Board shall register or seek recognition of the club as a recognized student organization. Recognition by the school and compliance with its policies govern school-based activities.

### SECTION 4. PURPOSE

The purpose of this chapter is to promote and uphold the principles of limited government, fiscal responsibility, free markets, and constitutional rights on campus through informed discussion, civic education, and lawful grassroots activism.

# ARTICLE II | MEMBERSHIP

## SECTION 1. VOTING MEMBERS

Voting membership shall be open to full-time and part-time students enrolled at Van High School who have attended at least one club meeting and remain in good standing with the school and applicable national organizational requirements. Voting members may participate in member votes and officer elections as provided by this Constitution.

## SECTION 2. ASSOCIATE MEMBERS AND EQUAL ACCESS

Associate members are non-students who support the club's goals. Subject to school visitor and event rules, they may participate in approved club activities, but may not vote or hold student officer positions. Membership is open without discrimination on the basis of race, color, religion, national origin, age, sex, veteran status, disability, or any other status protected by applicable law or school policy.

## SECTION 3. VOLUNTARY DEPARTURE AND NOTICE

A member may resign or withdraw from the club at any time; advance notice is **not** required. However, a departing member shall notify the President, Secretary, or faculty sponsor of the decision to leave, either at the time of departure or as soon as reasonably practicable. Leaving membership without any notice is contrary to the club's standards of courtesy and accurate recordkeeping. Notification does not require the member to continue participating and may not be used to prevent resignation.

An officer who resigns shall additionally arrange the prompt return of club property and the transfer of records, account access, and unfinished responsibilities to an authorized officer or sponsor.

# ARTICLE III | OFFICERS AND EXECUTIVE BOARD

## SECTION 1. GOVERNANCE AND DEFINED EXECUTIVE BOARD

Club affairs shall be managed by its officers, who are responsible for setting direction, enforcing rules, and overseeing club operations. The terms **"Executive Board," "Executive Board Members,"** and **"Board"** shall refer exclusively to the following **four** principal officers. No additional officer is a member of the Executive Board solely by virtue of that additional office:

- **President / Chief Executive Officer (CEO)**
- **Vice President / Chief Operating Officer (COO)**
- **Secretary / Executive Officer**
- **Treasurer / Chief Financial Officer (CFO)**

The four principal offices are mandatory. A three-fourths (3/4) vote of the four-member Executive Board requires at least **three affirmative votes**. Titles referring to the same person or office, such as "Vice President" and "COO," do not create additional seats or votes.

## SECTION 2. ADDITIONAL OFFICER POSITIONS

Two additional functions are essential to chapter operations: **Data Protection Officer (DPO)** and **Media Manager / Chief Marketing Officer (CMO)**. These positions should be filled when qualified students are available. When either position is vacant, its responsibilities shall fall collectively to the four Executive Board Members until filled or formally reassigned. The Executive Board may authorize further non-board officer roles as needed; such roles do not change its four-member composition.

## SECTION 3. DUTIES OF OFFICERS

### President / CEO

- Leads club meetings and events and serves as the primary liaison to school officials, the chapter network, and external partners.
- Appoints interim officers when vacancies occur, consistent with the vacancy procedures in this Constitution.
- Ensures the chapter adheres to its mission and possesses final administrative authority over the club's website management systems.
- Holds supreme operational authority over external banking, subject to the financial approval limits and governing policies in Article VI.

### Vice President / COO

- Assists the President, acts on the President's behalf when needed, and maintains order during meetings.
- Coordinates club activities and programming and oversees routine operational execution.

### Secretary / Executive Officer

- Maintains membership lists, official records, meeting minutes, and organizational documents.
- Distributes minutes and regular updates to members and assists with expenditure documentation and monthly reporting.

### Treasurer / CFO

- Oversees financial accounting, budget preparation, reimbursement records, and fundraising documentation.
- Reviews and verifies monthly expenditure sheets, receipts, and account reconciliations, without displacing the President's external banking authority.

### Data Protection Officer (DPO)

- Oversees data management, data protection, security, access controls, and responsible use of the public website, administrative website, and other online systems.
- Coordinates website operations with the CMO while remaining subordinate to the President's ultimate administrative authority.

### Media Manager / Chief Marketing Officer (CMO)

- Directs the club's social media presence, external messaging, media coverage, promotional content, and major marketing decisions.
- Documents events, coordinates media outreach, and works jointly with the DPO on website content and digital presentation.

## SECTION 4. ELECTION PROCESS AND TERMS

- Officer elections shall be held annually between **March 1 and May 31**.
- Candidates shall be announced at least **one week** before the election.
- Elected officers shall serve a term of **one calendar year**, beginning on Election Day, unless earlier removed or replaced in accordance with this Constitution.

### SECTION 5. OFFICER REMOVAL AND VACANCIES

An officer may be removed through both (a) a majority vote of the remaining officers and (b) a three-fourths (3/4) vote of the voting members. The officer concerned shall receive notice and a reasonable opportunity to respond, consistent with school policy. A vacant office shall be filled by officer appointment; the President may designate an interim appointee pending the appropriate appointment process. Vacancies in the Executive Board should be filled promptly so that the required four-member board is restored.

## ARTICLE IV | MEETINGS

- General membership meetings shall be held **at least once per month**.
- Each general meeting shall include at least one activism or academic discussion topic.
- Additional meetings may be scheduled by the officers, subject to school scheduling and approval requirements.

## ARTICLE V | BOOKS AND RECORDS

The Secretary and Treasurer/CFO shall maintain accurate and current records of meeting minutes, membership, club activities, financial transactions, budgets, contributions, and fundraisers. Club records shall be accessible to officers and, upon reasonable request, to members, except that personal data, account credentials, protected student information, and other confidential or security-sensitive materials shall be restricted to authorized individuals under applicable school rules and law.

## ARTICLE VI | EXTERNAL BANKING, SPENDING, AND FUNDRAISING

### SECTION 1. EXTERIOR BANKING AND ACCOUNT CUSTODY

The club's business checking account is maintained with **Altra Federal Credit Union**. The **President/CEO** shall maintain physical custody of the club's bank account card and possess **supreme operational authority over exterior banking**, including the club's direct relationship and routine external interactions with the financial institution. This authority is subject to the financial controls in this Constitution, institution agreements, and applicable school and legal requirements.

The President may authorize another officer or designated person to use and temporarily hold the card for a specified club purpose. Such delegation must be limited to the authorized transaction or period, documented for the Treasurer/CFO, and followed by prompt return of the card. Temporary card possession does not grant independent control over the account, confer Executive Board status, or waive the required purchase-approval threshold. Online banking credentials shall not be casually shared.

### SECTION 2. APPROVAL OF PURCHASES OVER $99.99

**Any purchase or expenditure exceeding $99.99** (that is, **$100.00 or more**) by **any** person acting for the club requires **prior approval by at least three of the four Executive Board Members**. The total charge, including applicable taxes, fees, shipping, and related costs, shall determine whether the threshold is met. This applies to card purchases, invoices, online services, reimbursements, and recurring payment commitments.

A proposal may not be artificially divided into smaller transactions to avoid approval. The President's external banking authority does not override this approval requirement. Expenditures at or below $99.99 remain subject to authorization, available funds, proper records, and other applicable policies.

### SECTION 3. MONTHLY FINANCIAL SHEET AND FULL-BOARD SIGN-OFF

A **monthly spending sheet** shall document every expenditure and reimbursement, including its date, purpose, amount, payee, form of payment, applicable approvals, and supporting receipt or invoice. The Secretary or an assigned officer shall compile the sheet and provide it to the **Treasurer/CFO**, who shall inspect it, compare it with account activity, and address discrepancies.

After CFO review, the completed monthly spending sheet shall be presented to and **signed off by all four Executive Board Members**. The signed sheet, account reconciliation, and supporting records shall be retained in the club's official files. Board sign-off confirms review of the documented month; it does not retroactively authorize a purchase that required prior approval.

### SECTION 4. FUNDRAISING CONDUCTED THROUGH THE SCHOOL

All fundraising conducted, sponsored, advertised, collected, or otherwise administered **through Van High School** shall follow the school's and district's applicable procedures, including faculty-sponsor coordination, required forms, administrative authorization, use-of-funds restrictions, and handling or deposit of proceeds.

Before a school-based fundraiser is submitted or launched, the Executive Board shall consider its purpose, proposed budget, estimated proceeds, responsible officers, timeline, and proposed handling of money. The **final internal club decision** to approve or reject the fundraiser shall be made by a **three-fourths (3/4) majority of the Executive Board (at least three of four affirmative votes)**. The Treasurer/CFO shall maintain fundraising income and expense records, with assistance from the Secretary.

This Executive Board decision is final **within the club**; however, it does not replace any required approval by the faculty sponsor, principal, district, or other school authority. No school-based fundraiser may begin without all required outside approvals, and school-controlled funds shall be processed according to school instructions. Any related expenditure of $100.00 or more also requires the purchase approval described in Section 2.

### SECTION 5. ANNUAL BUDGET AND FINANCIAL ACCOUNTABILITY

The Treasurer/CFO, working with the other officers, shall prepare an annual operating budget and track actual results against it. Receipts, bank records, fundraising records, and reimbursement documentation shall be maintained for transparency and transition between officer terms. Financial control shall be exercised only by those authorized under this Constitution, the credit union's agreements, and applicable school procedures.

## ARTICLE VII | WEBSITE ADMINISTRATION AND DIGITAL COMMUNICATIONS

### SECTION 1. ADMINISTRATIVE WEBSITE AND ULTIMATE AUTHORITY

The administrative website or dashboard used to manage the club's public website and connected online systems is an official club asset. The **President/CEO shall hold full, final, and highest administrative authority** over this platform, including ultimate control of ownership, access permissions, publishing authority, and system administration, subject to applicable law and school policy.

### SECTION 2. AUTHORITY OF THE DATA PROTECTION OFFICER

The **DPO** shall possess broad operational administrative privileges sufficient to manage website functionality, data protection, security configurations, user access, and routine technical administration. These privileges shall rank **below those of the President**. The DPO may not remove, suspend, demote, override, restrict, or alter the President's administrative privileges or ownership controls, nor exercise supervisory authority over the President on website matters.

### SECTION 3. CONTENT EDITING PRIVILEGES

The **Vice President/COO, Secretary/Executive Officer, Treasurer/CFO, and CMO** shall have appropriate permissions to edit content and update materials within their assigned responsibilities. Such access shall **not** include major platform control, system ownership, ultimate permissions management, or the ability to displace the President or DPO from their respective authorized roles. Editing privileges do not automatically create independent power to change structural governance or security policies.

### SECTION 4. DPO AND CMO COLLABORATION

When the DPO and CMO roles are held by different people, they shall **work together on website management**: the DPO leads technical operation, security, access, and data handling; the CMO leads branding, public-facing content, publishing coordination, and marketing presentation. If either role is vacant, its duties revert to the Executive Board under Article III, Section 2.

### SECTION 5. SECURITY, CONTINUITY, AND ACCOUNTABILITY

Official accounts, source files, credentials, public communications channels, and administrative systems shall be preserved as club assets. Access shall be limited by role; credentials and sensitive member data shall be handled securely; and outgoing officers shall transfer official account access and documents promptly. Any activity on these systems remains subject to school rules, platform terms, and applicable privacy requirements.

## ARTICLE VIII | AMENDMENTS AND CONTINUING REQUIREMENTS

### SECTION 1. AMENDMENT PROCEDURE

Amendments to this Constitution require both **at least a 67% affirmative vote of officers** and **at least a 75% affirmative vote of voting members present** at the meeting where the amendment is considered. The officer percentage is calculated using filled officer positions and shall be rounded up to the next whole vote when necessary. Voting members must receive notice of the proposed changes at least **two weeks in advance**.

### SECTION 2. CONTINUING CONSTITUTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

Regardless of later amendments, the organization shall maintain the four mandatory Executive Board offices identified in Article III: President/CEO, Vice President/COO, Secretary/Executive Officer, and Treasurer/CFO. Annual officer elections shall continue to be held between **March 1 and May 31**, and club activities shall remain subject to applicable school policies and law.

# CERTIFICATION & ATTESTATION

## EXECUTIVE BOARD ATTESTATION

We, the undersigned elected Executive Board officers of Club America at Van High School, operating under the official organizational name Club America Van Activism Hub and also known as Van Club America and Club America Van, hereby certify that the foregoing Chapter and Organizational Constitution was duly adopted as the governing constitutional document of the organization.

### PRESIDENT / CEO

Signature

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Date _____

### VICE PRESIDENT / COO

Signature

_____

Date _____

### EXECUTIVE OFFICER

Signature

_____

Date _____

### CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER

Signature

_____

Date _____